User Stories & Acceptance Criteria
Online Order Returns & Refund Process Improvement

Version: 1.0
Prepared By: Shubham Anand
Role: Business Analyst
Project: Portfolio Case Study

US-01 — View Return & Refund Status

User Story:
As a customer, I want to view the current status of my return and refund, so that I can understand the progress without contacting Customer Support**.**

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given the customer has an active return, when the customer views the return status, then the current return status shall be displayed.
- AC-02: Given the return status has changed, when the customer views the status again, then the latest status shall be displayed.
- AC-03: Given the refund has been confirmed by the payment provider, when the customer checks the refund status, then the updated refund status shall be visible.

US-02 — Receive Return & Refund Notifications

User Story:
As a customer, I want to receive notifications when my return or refund status changes, so that I can stay informed without repeatedly checking the status.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given a significant return-status change occurs, when the system records the new status, then the customer shall receive a notification.
- AC-02: Given the refund status changes, when the new status is recorded, then the customer shall receive a notification.
- AC-03: Given the refund is completed, when confirmation is received, then the customer shall receive a refund-completion notification.

US-03 — Check Return Eligibility

User Story:
As a Customer Support agent, I want to verify whether a return meets the applicable eligibility criteria, so that only eligible return requests proceed to authorization.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given a customer submits a return request, when the request is reviewed, then applicable return eligibility criteria shall be checked.
- AC-02: Given the return meets the eligibility criteria, when the check is completed, then the request shall be allowed to proceed to authorization.
- AC-03: Given the return does not meet the eligibility criteria, when the check is completed, then the request shall not proceed to authorization.

US-04 — Authorize Eligible Return

User Story:
As a Customer Support agent, I want to authorize an eligible return, so that the customer can proceed with returning the product.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given a return has passed the eligibility check, when the return is authorized, then it shall proceed to the return process.
- AC-02: Given a return has not passed the eligibility check, when authorization is attempted, then the return shall not proceed.
- AC-03: Given the return is authorized, when the authorization is completed, then the return shall be available for subsequent warehouse processing.

US-05 — Record Warehouse Inspection Result

User Story:
As a Warehouse / Returns associate, I want to record the inspection result of a returned item, so that the correct return status and next action can be determined.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given a returned product has been received, when the warehouse completes inspection, then the inspection result shall be recorded.
- AC-02: Given the item passes inspection, when the result is recorded, then the return status shall be updated accordingly.
- AC-03: Given the item fails inspection, when the result is recorded, then the return shall be marked as rejected or review-required.

US-06 — Prevent Rejected Return from Proceeding to Refund

User Story:
As a Warehouse / Returns associate, I want rejected returns to be prevented from automatically proceeding to refund processing, so that refunds are initiated only for valid returns.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given an item fails inspection, when the result is recorded as rejected, then the return shall not automatically proceed to refund processing.
- AC-02: Given the return requires additional review, when the inspection result is recorded, then its status shall remain visible as review-required.
- AC-03: Given the return is rejected or review-required, when an authorized user views the case, then the current status shall remain visible.

US-07 — Initiate Approved Refund

User Story:
As a Finance team member, I want to initiate a refund after the return has been approved, so that the customer can receive the refund.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given a returned item has successfully completed the required inspection, when the return is approved, then Finance shall be able to initiate the refund.
- AC-02: Given a return has been rejected, when refund initiation is attempted, then it shall not automatically proceed.
- AC-03: Given Finance initiates the refund, when the request is submitted, then it shall proceed to payment processing.

US-08 — Process Refund to Original Payment Method

User Story:
As a payment provider, I want to process an approved refund to the customer's original payment method, so that the refund can be completed correctly.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given an approved refund has been initiated, when the payment provider receives the refund request, then the refund shall be processed.
- AC-02: Given the original payment method is available, when the refund is processed, then the refund shall normally be returned to that payment method.
- AC-03: Given refund processing is completed, when the payment provider confirms the outcome, then the refund status shall be available for updating.

US-09 — Automatically Update Refund Status

User Story:
As an e-commerce system, I want to update the refund status after receiving confirmation from the payment provider, so that customers and support teams can see accurate refund information.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given the payment provider sends refund confirmation, when the e-commerce system receives it, then the refund status shall be updated.
- AC-02: Given the refund status is updated, when the customer views the return/refund status, then the latest information shall be displayed.
- AC-03: Given the refund status changes materially, when the update is recorded, then the notification process shall be triggered.

US-10 — Handle Exception Cases

User Story:
As a Customer Support agent, I want to assist customers with return and refund exception cases, so that unusual or unresolved issues can still receive human support.

Acceptance Criteria:

- AC-01: Given a return or refund cannot be resolved through the normal process, when the case requires assistance, then Customer Support shall be able to review the case.
- AC-02: Given a return is marked as rejected or review-required, when Customer Support accesses the case, then the current status shall be visible.
- AC-03: Given an exception requires human intervention, when support reviews the case, then the case shall remain available for manual handling.